



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Information Management

RESTAURANT AND FOOD SERVICES MANAGEMENT SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the need for hospitality and tourism business information
2. Assess information needs
3. Analyze trends in food habits/preferences
4. Apply information to accomplish a task
5. Obtain needed information efficiently

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the Marketing Manager for THE HARVEST HUB, a casual-dining restaurant that prides itself on "classic comfort food." The owner (judge) is considering a major marketing shift toward "sustainability" and "plant-forward" dining but needs data to justify the change.

THE HARVEST HUB is located in a college town with a population of 50,000. While the restaurant is currently successful, the owner (judge) has noticed that the younger demographic (Generation Z and Millennials) is increasingly frequenting a competitor that markets "ethical sourcing" and "carbon-neutral" ingredients.

Recent industry reports suggest that a large percentage of consumers are trying to add more plant-based or "flexitarian" options to their diets. However, your current menu is heavily focused on steaks, burgers, and traditional dairy-heavy sides. The owner (judge) wants to know if your current customer base actually cares about these sustainability trends or if a marketing pivot would alienate your loyal "comfort food" regulars.

The owner (judge) has asked you to design a marketing research plan to determine:

- What specific food habits and preferences your customers currently have regarding sustainable or plant-based options.
- The method you will use to collect this feedback efficiently (e.g., kiosks, mobile apps, or surveys).
- Specific questions to ask that will help decide if the menu should be expanded.
- An incentive to encourage customers to participate in the research.

You will present your plan to the owner (judge) in a role-play to take place in the owner's office. The owner (judge) will begin the role-play by asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented and answered questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Why is it important to get customer feedback before we spend money on a new marketing campaign?
2. How can we be sure the people taking the survey are our actual customers and not just random people online?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the need for hospitality and tourism business information?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Assess information needs?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Analyze trends in food habits/preferences?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Apply information to accomplish a task?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Obtain needed information efficiently?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						